

IBM's grid games

Grid computing is still in the conceptual state, but IBM is all set to do wonders with it. It has tied up with *Butterfly.net* to build a worldwide network for online video games to be rented out to major game publishers. This network can support more than a million



players. 'Butterfly Grid' is one of the first commercial applications of grid computing.

The advantages of this network when compared to present day online interactive games lie in the lower costs of deployment, support for more simultaneous users and the reduction in the number of interruptions owing to Net congestion. This will enable game studios to release games with massive multi-player support at reduced production costs and speedier development cycles.

IBM is providing the hardware while *Butterfly.net* takes care of the software aspect. *Butterfly.net* is also providing software developer kits for PC and console game makers to enable support in their games for the Butterfly Grid.

snapshot

367 million
PCs will be in use in
the Asia-Pacific
region by **2007**

Source: cyberatlas.internet.com

Who runs your life?

This seems to be the question that MSN's online reality show, modelled after the *Big Brother* reality TV show, asks its participants. This show has five participants whose daily decisions are made by netizens. Every day, partici-

from Scotland as the winner. This 36-year-old engineer had to give up his career in Scotland and move to Spain. But he did pocket a handsome £10,000 in prize money. Other life changing decisions included 25-year-old stockbroker Nik



pants have to submit a decision they need to make. Web surfers can vote and decide what the participants should do. Contestants have to follow the majority's decision.

The experiment received 300,000 votes cast over the 15 days it ran and saw the emergence of John Duncanson

Jones dyeing her hair pink, selling her house and car. Clare Perkins, 27, was made to take part in a nude modelling session! In today's modern society where children don't listen to their parents, blindly following the advice of a group of unknowns seems rather foolhardy, doesn't it?

quoteworthy

"If I rob a bank, the fact that I haven't been arrested yet doesn't mean I haven't done something wrong"

Matt Oppenheim, Sr Vice President Business and Legal Affairs, RIAA about KaZaA having escaped their clutches

"The best teams are forged during difficult times, not easy times"

Hewlett-Packard CEO, Carly Fiorina, addressing the newly merged HP-Compaq workforce

"Software always will have flaws"

Christopher Budd, Microsoft Security Program Manager, talking about Microsoft's company-wide campaign to reduce security flaws in their software

tomorrow's technology

Light and fast

Extreme Ultraviolet Lithography (EUVL) is a new technology for making microprocessors faster by a hundred fold. This could make processors with speeds in excess of 10 GHz a reality in the not so distant future.

EUVL is vying to replace the current optical lithography technology that is used to make microcircuits. It works by burning intense beams of reflected UV light into a silicon wafer.

Microchips made using EUVL will have etched circuit lines smaller than 0.1 micron in width as compared to today's circuits that generally have a width of 0.13 microns or greater.

Intel will be the first chip-maker to get hold of a beta version of the tool in 2005. Other chip manufacturers such as AMD, IBM, Motorola, Infineon and Micron Technologies will also get their hands on these tools as

they're part of the EUVL LLC. EUVL LLC is a consortium of the big shots from the microprocessor industry to conduct research and development in this field.

Although the alpha version of the tool has been around since 2001, the beta version is only expected in the year 2005.

Commercial production of chips using this new technology is expected five years from now.